

Experiment 3: tree, head, and tail Commands in Kali Linux

AIM

To execute and display the results of the following commands in the Kali Linux operating system:

- `tree` command
- `head` command
- `tail` command

PROCEDURE

1. Open **Kali Linux**.
2. Open the **Terminal**.
3. Create a sample directory with some files.
4. Use the `tree` command to display the directory structure.
5. Create a text file containing multiple lines.
6. Use the `head` command to display the first lines of the file.
7. Use the `tail` command to display the last lines of the file.
8. Observe and record the output.

CODE / COMMANDS

A. `tree` Command

Purpose

The `tree` command displays files and directories in a **tree-like hierarchical structure**.

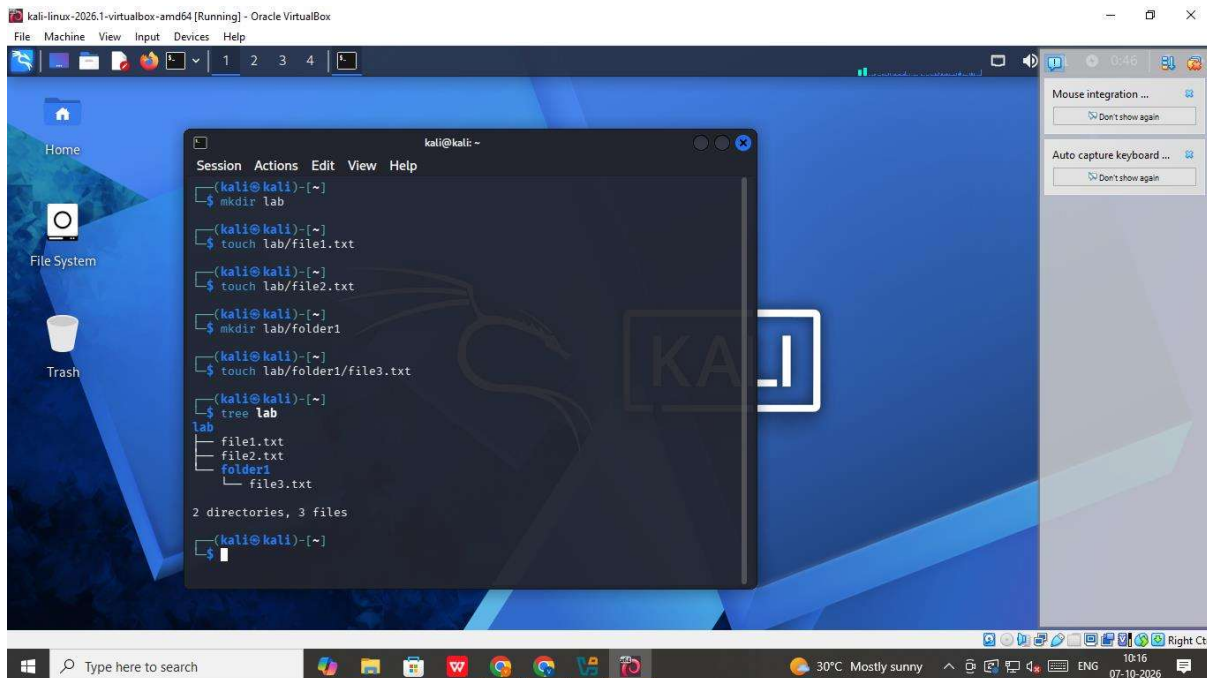
Command

```
mkdir lab
touch lab/file1.txt
touch lab/file2.txt
mkdir lab/folder1
touch lab/folder1/file3.txt
tree lab
```

Sample Input

```
mkdir lab
touch lab/file1.txt
touch lab/file2.txt
mkdir lab/folder1
touch lab/folder1/file3.txt
tree lab
```

Sample Output



The screenshot shows a Kali Linux desktop environment with a terminal window open. The terminal displays the following commands and their output:

```
kali@kali: ~  
$ mkdir lab  
$ touch lab/file1.txt  
$ touch lab/file2.txt  
$ mkdir lab/folder1  
$ touch lab/folder1/file3.txt  
$ tree lab  
lab  
├── file1.txt  
├── file2.txt  
└── folder1  
    └── file3.txt  
  
2 directories, 3 files  
$
```

The terminal window is titled "kali@kali: ~" and has a menu bar with "Session", "Actions", "Edit", "View", and "Help". The desktop background is blue with a "KALI" logo. On the left, there are icons for "Home", "File System", and "Trash". On the right, there are panels for "Mouse integration ..." and "Auto capture keyboard ...". The bottom of the screen shows a Windows taskbar with various application icons and a system tray displaying "30°C Mostly sunny", "10:16", "ENG", and "07-10-2026".

B. head Command

Purpose

The head command displays the **first 10 lines** of a text file by default.

Command

First create a file:

```
cat > numbers.txt
```

Sample input:

Enter:

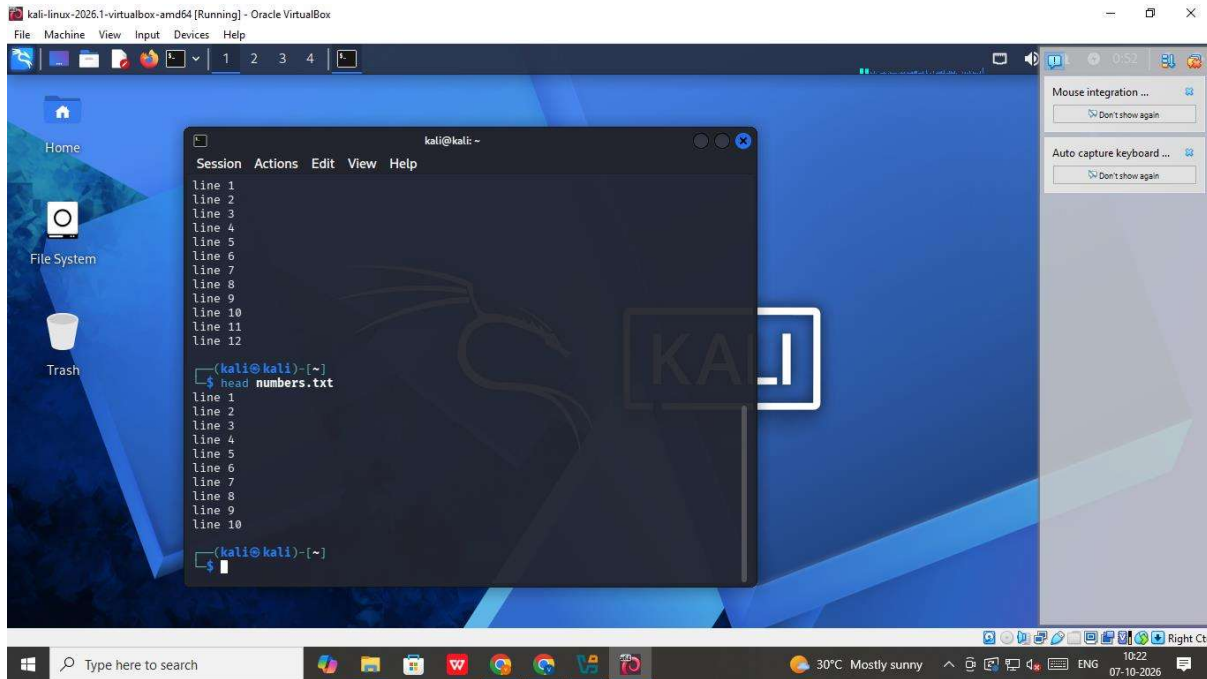
```
Line 1  
Line 2  
Line 3  
Line 4  
Line 5  
Line 6  
Line 7  
Line 8  
Line 9  
Line 10  
Line 11  
Line 12
```

Press **Ctrl + D** to save.

Then execute:

```
head numbers.txt
```

Sample Output



```
kali@kali: ~  
Session Actions Edit View Help  
line 1  
line 2  
line 3  
line 4  
line 5  
line 6  
line 7  
line 8  
line 9  
line 10  
line 11  
line 12  
$ head numbers.txt  
line 1  
line 2  
line 3  
line 4  
line 5  
line 6  
line 7  
line 8  
line 9  
line 10  
$
```

C. tail Command

Purpose

The tail command displays the **last 10 lines** of a text file by default.

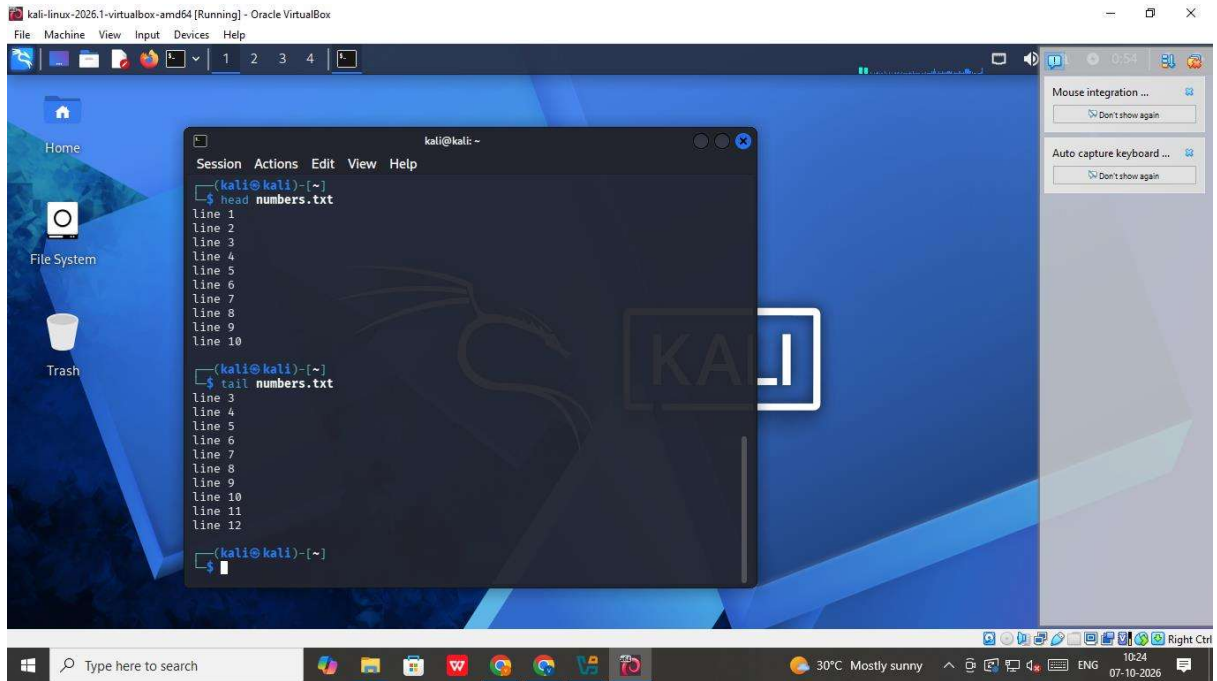
Command

```
tail numbers.txt
```

Sample Output

```
Line 3  
Line 4  
Line 5  
Line 6  
Line 7  
Line 8  
Line 9  
Line 10  
Line 11  
Line 12
```

Sample Output



The screenshot shows a Kali Linux desktop environment within an Oracle VM VirtualBox window. A terminal window is open, displaying the output of the `head` and `tail` commands on a file named `numbers.txt`. The `head` command shows the first 10 lines of the file, and the `tail` command shows the last 12 lines. The desktop background is blue with a large 'KALI' logo. The taskbar at the bottom shows various application icons and system status information.

```
kali@kali: ~  
$ head numbers.txt  
line 1  
line 2  
line 3  
line 4  
line 5  
line 6  
line 7  
line 8  
line 9  
line 10  
$ tail numbers.txt  
line 3  
line 4  
line 5  
line 6  
line 7  
line 8  
line 9  
line 10  
line 11  
line 12  
$
```

4. RESULT

The `tree`, `head`, and `tail` commands were successfully executed in **Kali Linux**.

- **tree** – Displays the directory and file structure.
- **head** – Displays the beginning of a file.
- **tail** – Displays the end of a file.